

Components Of Cognitive Conceptualisation

Cognitive conceptualisation refers to a systematic procedure used in Cognitive Behaviour Therapy (CBT) for assessing how thoughts, feelings and actions are interrelated within an individual. The method is employed for establishing underlying themes responsible for emotional disturbance and developing intervention strategies. The components are as follows:

Core beliefs: Core beliefs are considered among the important aspects in cognitive conceptualisation. Such beliefs involve fundamental perceptions that people hold regarding themselves, other individuals and the environment. Core beliefs are developed during the formative years, especially after experiencing critical events, including interaction with parents and peers. Core beliefs are considered inflexible, omnipresent and overgeneralized. For instance an individual who encountered criticism during their early years may develop core beliefs such as "I am inadequate."

Intermediate beliefs: Intermediate beliefs include assumptions, rules and attitudes. Intermediate beliefs are considered a bridge between core beliefs and automatic thoughts. The conditional structure "If, then" or rule form is usually used when representing intermediate beliefs. The person who has core belief that he/she lacks something has the following intermediate belief "If I don't do everything perfectly, then "I will fail" or "It is necessary to satisfy other peoples expectations." These intermediate beliefs impact people's attitude towards a particular situation and the way it will be resolved.

Automatic thoughts: Automatic thoughts represent spontaneous and involuntary thoughts that appear in response to specific triggers. They are characterized by their automatic nature, being brief, habitual and unnoticeable. They are influenced by core or intermediate beliefs and considerably shape emotions and behaviours. A good example here is a student who has received average results in an examination and feels like a failure, even though such self-evaluation can be far from truth.

Situations: It refers the common events which provokes thoughts and feelings in our minds. Situations can either occur externally as well as internally to us. While external situations may include feedback from a teacher or an examination, internal ones may be triggered by recollecting a past experience or having certain emotions. The interpretation of the situation holds great importance than its nature. For instance, if a student is criticized for his assignment, the response may vary widely between two individuals.

In conclusion, cognitive conceptualization consists of the assessment of how central beliefs, intermediate beliefs, automatic thoughts, situations and emotions or behaviours are interrelated.